

Light House

Designed by VICTORIA WANG

After escaping terror,
the real terror lies ahead.

For model assets, please visit:
https://victoria-wang.itch.io/lighthouse

INSPIRATION



SETTING

Solaris

A literary work by Polish science fiction author Stanislaw Lem. It depicts a mysterious ocean capable of materialising the private thoughts and dark impulses within the human mind.



PLOT

My Dream

A group of people found themselves trapped within a lighthouse-like facilit. Periodically, water would flood the structure, and as the tide receded, one person would vanish.



HORROR

Rules Horror

Weird rules constitute a distinctive literary genre, typically presented in the guise of regulations, bylaws, or brief notes. Readers must then deduce the sequence of events and uncover the truth within this distorted framework.



ARCHITECTURE

The Nakagin Capsule Tower

The Bank of China Capsule Hotel is a collective residential building situated in Tokyo's Ginza district. As the most renowned example of Japan's Metabolism architectAural movement, it displays a strikingly futuristic style and science-fiction-like conception.

BACKGROUND



Inside **Lighthouse**, a surface base on an alien planet, the sole survivor awakens, having lost much of his memory. As he explores, he discovers himself torn between two sets of rules:

AI Minerva's **sterile treatment** is actually an elimination program targeting mutated individuals;



while the Ocean Consciousness forges escape guides in red text, luring him into voluntary fusion.

The protagonist's cognitive contamination is irreversible—whichever side he chooses, the end of his human identity awaits him.

What will he choose?

The red text

The red text is the physical trace of the alien consciousness's infiltration, existing in a warm, viscous liquid form. It can evade Minerva's monitoring and forge **rules** and **diaries** brimming with human fear and the will to survive by mimicking the victims' handwriting and tone. It is both the key to uncovering the concealed truth and the poison that lures survivors into embracing assimilation voluntarily.

SYSTEM DESIGN

CSI System

The **CSI** (Cognitive Stability Index) is the most important status value in the game.

Positive CSI: The player trusts the claims of the AI **Minerva** and believes the base is safe, but will miss many hidden clues and the truth.



Positive CSI

Negative CSI: The player starts to see the **truth** of the world, yet will also face more direct horrors and become a target for pursuit.



Negative CSI

Drinking the **Red Beverage** is a pivotal choice that changes the gameplay.

Before drinking it: The player's **CSI** will be no lower than 0. The player needs to evade a monster called **the Shadow** and manage their CSI.


Scene before the player drinking Red Beverage

Once consumed: The player's CSI will permanently turn negative. The advantage is that they can see all hidden information to advance the plot; the disadvantage is that they will be permanently hunted by robots called the Sentinel and will no longer be able to use Energy Elixir.



Scene after the player drinking Red Beverage

The CSI directly drives the survival gameplay and the ending.
In dangerous areas, the CSI will keep decreasing. If it drops too low, it will trigger a **Shadow** chase sequence.

Time & Save System

The game features a hard time limit of **7** in-game days. Once the countdown ends, the finale will be triggered automatically.

Players have only **6** manual save opportunities throughout the entire gameplay, and saving can only be performed in the Personal Quarters. Save points are not just progress checkpoints, but also critical strategic resources—players must carefully plan when to use them).

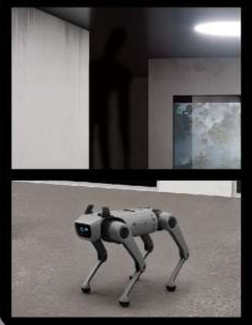

Player's Personal Quarter: In-Game Save Point

Explore and solve puzzles within the specified time limit to find the hidden path that breaks the forced finale.

Exploration & Threat System

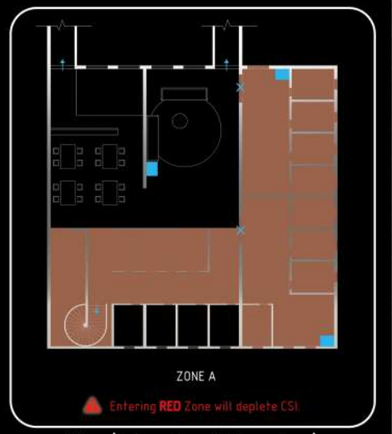
The map is split into AI-controlled Zones (relatively safe) and Entity-contaminated Zones.
The map is split into **AI-controlled Zones** (relatively safe) and **Entity-contaminated Zones**. Inside contaminated zones, CSI will continuously deplete on its own, creating an intense pressure of **cognitive attrition**.

Dual Threats



The Shadow: When CSI drops below a specific threshold, these entities will materialize and trigger a chase sequence—players must flee the area at once.

Sentinel-Prime Robots: These units will be permanently activated to actively hunt down players after they consume Red Fluid and their CSI turns negative.



Map(Standard Version)

Resource System

Key Items

Energy Elixir: Usable only when CSI is positive. It can restore or maintain positive CSI, serving as a safeguard to delay cognitive collapse and enable safe exploration within contaminated zones.


Energy Elixir

Red Beverage: Consuming it will permanently send CSI into a negative state. It can also be used as a **booster**: actively drinking it while CSI is negative will drastically enhance perception in the short term (unveiling more truths), but it will accelerate CSI depletion and amplify incoming threats.


Red Beverage


Fake Energy Elixir

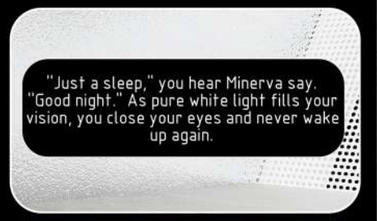
Ending System

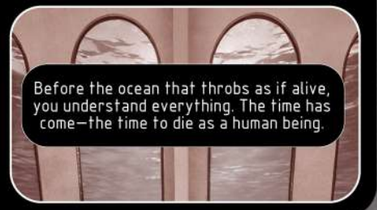
Forced Endings

At the end of Day 7, the outcome is determined mandatorily based on the final CSI value:
CSI ≥ 0: Sanity remains intact, yet contamination is irreversible. Minerva transfers you to the Advanced Sanitarium and erases your consciousness.
CSI < 0: Minerva designates you as a **Contamination Source** and initiates physical elimination.

Hidden Ending

By fulfilling a series of complex conditions within the time limit and making specific choices, you can trigger the true ending that transcends the two outcomes above—it is the ultimate objective of the game.





PROCESS

The game lets you save seven times in total, and each save represents one day passing. The process is roughly divided into three stages:

DAY1

Familiarize yourself with the gameplay and story, and conduct initial exploration

DAY2

The appearance of the Red Beverage marks the branching point of the story

DAY3-6

Drink the Red Beverage?

No → Gather information, unlock other zones, and evade the Shadow

Yes → Drink the Red Beverage, and the Shadow will no longer be hostile, while the Sentinel-Prime Droids turn hostile. → Gather information, unlock other zones, and evade theSentinel-Prime Droids

Key information fully collected?

No → CSI < 0?

- No → ENDING1 Advanced Sanitarium: You are humanely euthanized by Minerva.
- Yes → ENDING2 Contamination Source: You were eliminated as a monster.

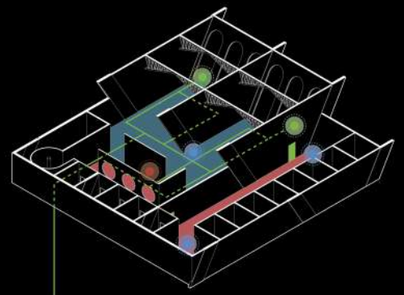
Yes → CSI < 0?

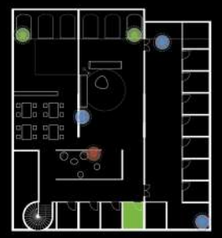
- No → Flee to the tower?
  - No → ENDING3 No Escape: You decide to return to Minerva and face purification and death.
  - Yes → ENDING5 Death of a Nameless: In this fake lighthouse, you choose to die as a human being.
- Yes → Flee to the tower?
  - Yes → ENDING5 Death of a Nameless: In this fake lighthouse, you choose to die as a human being.
  - No → ENDING4 Welcome Home: You felt the planet. This time, you did not resist.

DAY7(Ending)

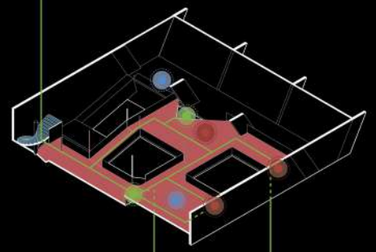
MAP DESIGN

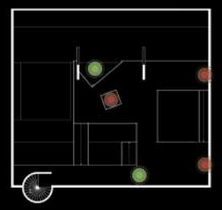
As exploration progresses, different areas of the map will be unlocked. For example, the distribution of interactive resource points unlocked on the first day is shown in the figure:



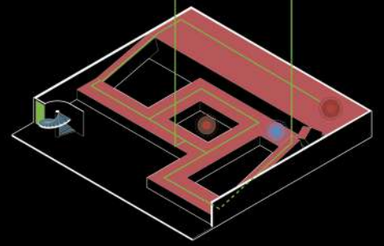


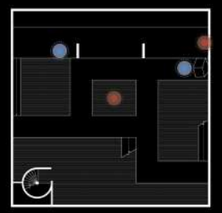
The first floor is the lounge. The green room at the bottom right of the floor plan is the resting room. No matter the current state, entering this room will immediately save the game, reset the state, and move on to the next day.



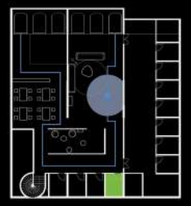


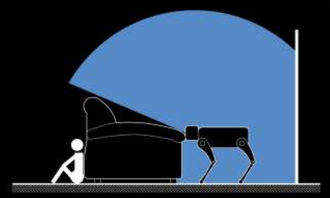
The entire basement is a contaminated area. The player can go down via the spiral staircase.The CSI keeps dropping when in a contaminated area. Drinking energy elixir, which can be found at marked spots, will restore the CSI.





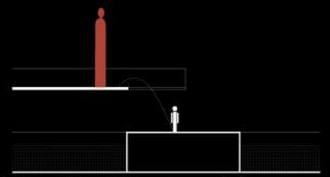
- Contaminated items
- Energy Elixir
- Other interaction points



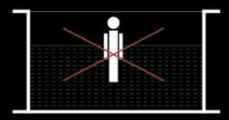


When CSI is less than 0, the player will be attacked by **Sentinel-Prime Robots**. They have set patrol routes and detection ranges. Once they detect an infected person, they will leave their route and speed up to chase them until the infected person gets out of range or is eliminated. Their detection beams can be blocked by furniture or walls.





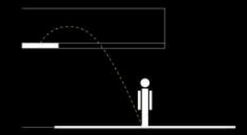
When **the CSI** drops below **50** and the player is in a contaminated area, **the Shadow** will respawn near the nearest contaminated object to the player. **The Shadow** will keep chasing the player until he restore his CSI or leave the contaminated area. The shadow can only walk on the ground, so the player can quickly create distance by jumping off platforms at gaps in the railings.



Falling into the pool without drinking the red beverage will lead to death.



Crouching can help you avoid the robot's detection.



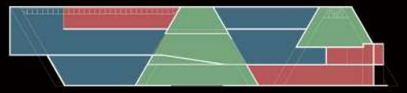
You can jump down from certain gaps, but you can't jump up to high places.

MAP DESIGN



6.LIGHTHOUSE, ???

END



START



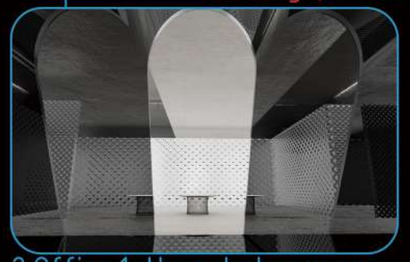
1.Your room, safe



2.Lounge, the shadow appears



5.Control Room, the robots appear



2.Office 1, the robots appear



5.Office 2, the shadow appears



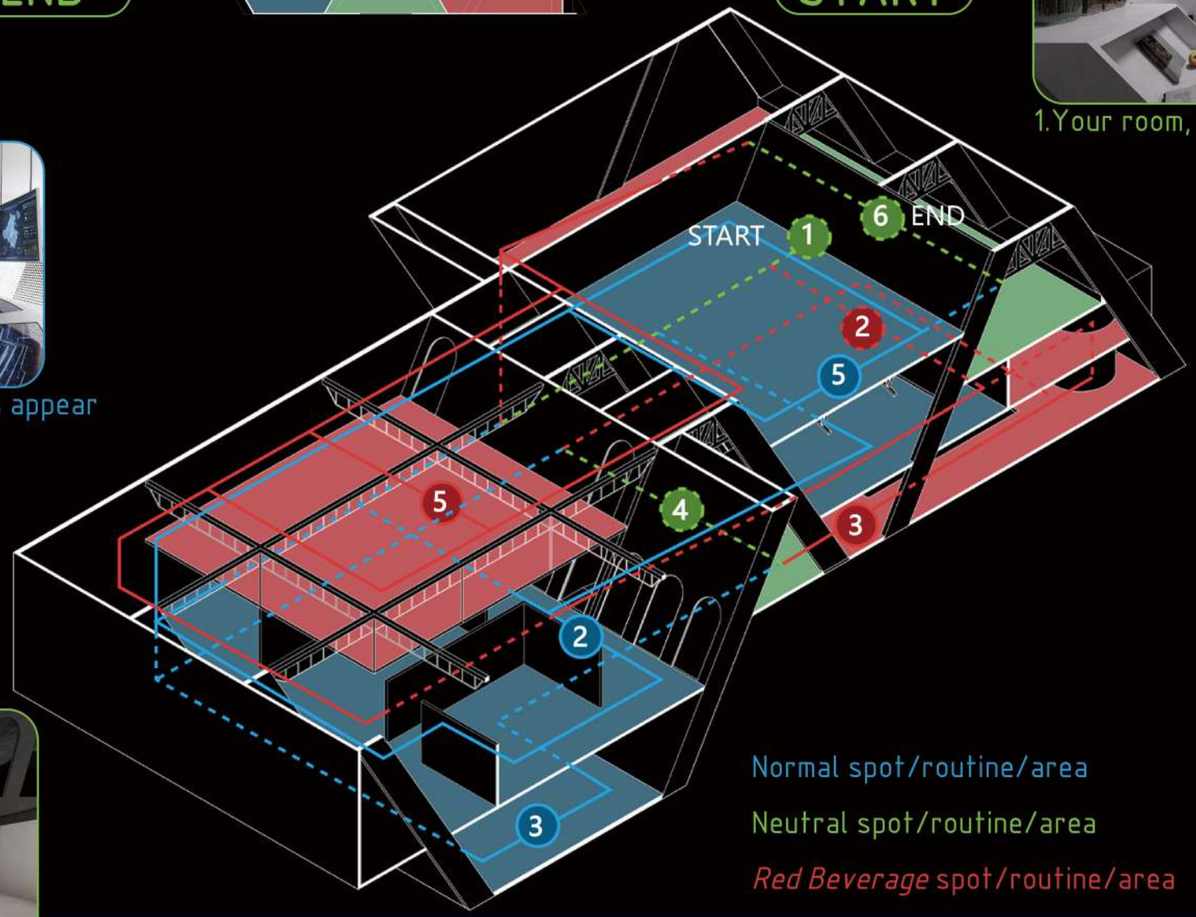
3.Laboratory α, the shadow appears



4.Covered bridge, safe



3.Laboratory β, the robots appear



Normal spot/routine/area

Neutral spot/routine/area

Red Beverage spot/routine/area

SPATIAL DESIGN

The spatial design takes into account the atmosphere needed for the story and is roughly divided into 3 types of spaces:

Entity-contaminated Zones: These kinds of spaces will corrupt players and spawn entities, so they're pretty dark and chaotic, giving people an unsettling feeling.

AI-controlled Zones: These kinds of spaces symbolize safety and control, so they're bright and modern, while also giving off a sense of being watched and a bit of an inorganic feel.

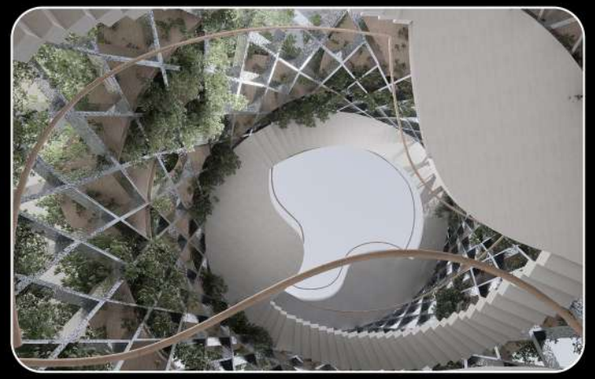
The Tower Light House: This space carries the climax and ending of the story. The sequence of spaces aligns with the player's psychological changes. It has a surreal atmosphere.

The Tower *Light House*

When the player is in the lead space, the light focuses on the main body of the tower, giving a sense of hope.



The spiral staircase ramps up the player's anticipation for a successful escape.



The vertical upward space suddenly opens into a horizontal space.The player has nowhere to escape.



Entity-contaminated Zones

The lighting is dim, the space is low and cramped, which feels uncomfortable mentally.

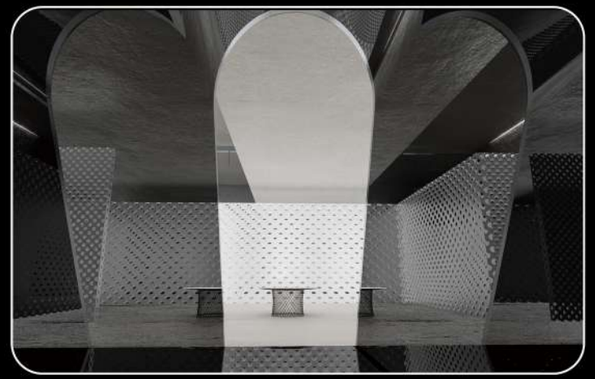


The space is relatively enclosed, with obvious signs of corrosion, stains, and traces of human activity.



AI-controlled Zones

A space that's too tall gives off an inhuman sense of scale and has a cold, technological vibe.



The space is tidy and bright, with few signs of human activity, giving a sense of distance.

